

As for operating system support, every printer in this category supported Windows, Linux and Mac

Thankfully, all printers in this category had USB 2.0 capability, as well as a parallel port connection. Networking was more important though, and all except the Xerox 3420P were either network-ready or offered an upgrade option. We fail to fathom how Xerox omitted a networking option on their heavy duty printers.

In terms of build quality, the Samsung ML2250 was a clear winner, with the Samsung 2551N coming in second. Both these printers are extremely sturdy.

Rounding up the bottom half was the WeP 2500, which really looked shoddy compared to the Samsungs. To be fair to it, though, it's not like the WeP would crumble if you touched it, and was reasonably sturdy—it's just that the Samsungs are just built like brick walls!

Performance

We now come to the part where we stop judging a book by its cover, and put these devices through the rigours as we did in the SoHo category.

In terms of warm-up speeds, none could touch the Brother 5170DN and 6050D. They clocked just 5.9 and 6 seconds respectively for their warm-ups.

The worst performer here was the WeP 2500 with a whopping 20-minute load up time. The first time you insert a toner cartridge, it loads a lot of toner to enable subsequent faster printing, which was apparent later on, as this was one of our faster printers from here on! The Xerox Phaser 3420P came in third behind the Brothers with a time of 19 seconds.

Though warm-up times are important, if you need to print documents continuously, you need not pay too much attention to these times.

Moving on with the speed tests, the WeP 2500 easily outclassed everyone here with text print times (Normal and Best) of 9.35 and 9.377 seconds respectively, followed by the Brother 6050D at 10.95 and 13.29 seconds respectively.

Coming in last was Xerox with scores of 13.52 and 15.11 seconds respectively.

For the combi-document, the Samsung beat the WeP with ease, logging times of 12.75 and 14.53 seconds, as compared to 16.3 and 18.12 seconds for the WeP 2500.



Brother HL 6050D

WISDOM OF THE ORIENT SERIES #25

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"Wise men subscribe
when the time is ripe.
The unwise keep
waiting for a better offer
that may never come"

BHEI TU CHEK, PHILOSOPHER

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